Boundless Informant and More Revelations

On June 8, the third article written by Greenwald was published. It detailed a data mining tool called Boundless Informant. The tool mapped, by country, the amount of information the NSA collected from telephone and computer networks. The leaked document showed the NSA had collected nearly 3 billion pieces of communications data during February 2013 alone.[6] A color-coded map showed that most intelligence was gathered from Iran, Pakistan, Jordan, Egypt, and India. The document proved that statements made by the Intelligence Community—that it was impossible for them to estimate how many communications were collected—were not true.

In the following months, many more stories resulting

FISA COURT

In 1978, the US Congress created the FISA court to oversee US Intelligence Community activities and assure their lawfulness. Composed of federal judges appointed by the chief justice of the US Supreme Court, the court is held in secret and most of its decisions are also secret. When submitting wiretap and search warrant requests for approval, the government must show the surveillance target is a foreign power or an agent of a foreign power; it does not need to show probable cause that a crime is being committed.

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